Journal Template

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1 Features

This template provides an out-of-box experience for turning a written article into a journal issue, which can be used for both print and online versions.

1.1 Compatibility

This template is compatible with the template in [1]. This means that you can write your article using [1] and then directly copy and paste the content into this template. The only modification you need to make is to change the "section" commands to "chapter" commands.

1.2 Two formats

This template provides two formats for the journal issue: a print format and an online format.

Print This format is designed for printing the journal issue. It uses a two-sided layout, which means that the headers are different on odd and even pages, the margins are adjusted accordingly, and chapters start on odd pages. The front and back covers are not included in the document, for the convenience of printing and binding.

Online This format is designed for online reading of the journal issue. It uses a one-sided layout. The front and back covers are directly included in the document.

You can run `./build.sh` to build both formats, and the output files will be saved in the `target/` directory. See Chapter 2 for more details on how to build the journal issue.

1.3 Cover design

The covers of the journal issue is designed with Inkscape, which is a free and open-source vector graphics editor. The source files of the covers are included in the `resources/` directory, and you can modify them directly (e.g., update the volume and issue numbers).

`./resources/export.sh` is a script that can be used to export the covers from `.svg` format to `.png` format, which is the format used in the journal issue. This is because GitHub actions do not support Inkscape, so we cannot directly use the `.svg` files in the journal issue.

1.4 GitHub actions

This template uses GitHub actions to automate the building and publishing of the journal issue. When you push changes to the `main` branch, the GitHub action will automatically build both formats of the journal issue and publishes them onto GitHub Pages. The published journal issue can be accessed at https://xxcc-unicorn-press.github.io/<repo-name>.

1.5 Synchronization with template updates

When the template repository is updated, you can use `sync-template` CLI tool to synchronize the changes. See https://github.com/XXCC-Unicorn-Press/sync-template for more details on how to use this tool. The following files and directories will be ignored during the synchronization process, to avoid overwriting your content:

- `content/`
- `figures/`
- `preamble/meta.tex`
- `preamble/custom.tex`
- `references.bib`

You may need to resolve some merge conflicts manually, but most of the changes will be automatically merged by Git.

2 Usage

2.1 Create the project

There are two ways to create a journal issue project:

- Create a GitHub repository with template `XXCC-Unicorn-Press/journal-template` and clone the repository to your local machine.
- Run `git clone --depth 1 <repository-url>` to clone this repository to your local machine.

After creating the project, run `./build.sh` to build the journal issue. The output files will be saved in the `target/` directory.

2.2 Migrate content from article projects

Copy the following files from your article project to the journal issue project:

`content/` `figures/` `preamble/custom.tex` `references.bib`

Then modify `main.tex` to include the content files. You should place front matter files (e.g., introduction) to after `\frontmatter` and main content files (e.g., features) to after `\mainmatter`.

Finally, promote the title levels in the content files, like "`\section`" to "`\chapter`". This can be done by giving the following prompt to an AI assistant:

> I am migrating an article project into a journal issue. The source files are located in the `content/` directory.
>
> I need to promote the heading levels throughout the project (e.g., converting `\section` to `\chapter`, `\subsection` to `\section`, and so on). This adjustment should apply to all relevant occurrences, including but not limited to:
>
> **Structuring commands**: `\section`, `\subsection`, etc.
> **Cross-references**: Labels (e.g., `\label{sec:...}`), references (e.g., `\ref{sec:...}`), and related plain text (e.g., "the previous section").
>
> **Important:** Please ensure these changes are context-aware. Do not modify "section" when it refers to different mathematical or logical concepts (e.g., "section of a fibration") or when it appears within citation arguments (e.g., `\cite[section 1.2]{...}`).

2.3 Modify the metadata

Modify the metadata in `preamble/metadata.tex`, including the journal title, volume number, issue number, publication date, and so on. Update the front cover `resources/frontcover.svg` with the correct volume and issue numbers. **Remember** to run `./resources/export.sh` to export the covers from `.svg` format to `.png` format, which is the format used in the journal issue.

In addition, you may add some extra pages, like dedication, editorial, and so on. Put those files in the `frontmatter/` directory and `\include` them in `main.tex` after `\frontmatter`.

2.4 Publish the journal issue

Before you publish the journal issue, please follow the checklist below to make sure everything is ready:

- Have you updated the metadata in `preamble/metadata.tex`?
- Have you updated the front cover with the correct volume and issue numbers?
- Have you run `./resources/export.sh` to export the covers?
- Have you built the journal issue by running `./build.sh`?
- Have you checked the output files in the `target/` directory?

After you have checked everything, push the changes to the `main` branch to publish the journal issue onto GitHub Pages. Then you can update the website of the publisher to include the new journal issue.

Bibliography

[1] XXCC Unicorn Press. *Article Template*. 2026.
URL: https://github.com/XXCC-Unicorn-Press/article-template.

[2] XXCC Unicorn Press. *Journal Template*. 2026.
URL: https://github.com/XXCC-Unicorn-Press/journal-template.